ESC180: Introduction to Computer Programming

Exam Review

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1 Python Fundamentals

1.1 Comments and Output

We can use the `print()` function to display text or output values. Text must be inside quotes, otherwise Python will return a syntax error.

Example.

```
print("Hello world!")
print("I love Praxis!") # Automatically prints on a new line
```

Output.

```
Hello world!
I love Praxis!
```

Any text after `#` is a comment. These will not be read by Python, and are used to make code more readable. You can also do math inside of a print statement. Observe the absence of quotes.

Example.

```
print("What is 3 + 10?")
print("3 + 10 =", 3 + 10) # Prints 13, as 3 + 10 = 13
```

Output.

```
What is 3 + 10?
3 + 10 = 13
```

1.2 Variables and Data Types

Here are some commonly used data types in Python.

Data Type	Example
str	`"hi!"`
int	`120`
float	`12.5`
bool	`True`
list	`["an", "ban", "can"]`
tuple	`("an", "ban", "can")`
dict	`{"ESC101": 70, "ESC194": 100}`

Variables are used to store data values. A variable is created when you assign a value to it with the assignment operator, `=`.

Example.

```
toggled = False
name = "John Doe"

x1 = 50 # stores 50
x2 = float(50) # stores 50.0

y1 = 11.1 # stores 11.1
y2 = int(11.1) # stores 11
```

Observe how Python automatically determines the type of a variable, unless you explicitly cast a different data type.

1.2.1 Interlude (Local and Global Variables)

Variables that are created outside of a function are known as global variables. Global variables can be used by everyone, both inside of functions and outside. Variables that are created inside a function are known as local variables. Local variables can only be used inside their functions. We can however create global variables inside a function by using the `global` keyword.

1.3 Booleans and Operators

Comparing two values generates a Boolean value, `True` or `False`. You can also use `bool()`, which will return `True` unless you pass in numeric zeros, empty sequences/collections, or `None` in which case `False` is returned.
Here are some arithmetic operators.

Arithmetic Operator	Name
+	Addition
-	Subtraction
*	Multiplication
/	Division
%	Modulus
**	Exponentiation
//	Floor division

Here are some assignment operators.

Assignment Operator	Example	Equivalent To
=	`x = 10`	`x = 10`
+=	`x += 10`	`x = x + 10`
-=	`x -= 10`	`x = x - 10`
*=	`x *= 10`	`x = x * 10`
/=	`x /= 10`	`x = x / 10`
%=	`x %= 10`	`x = x % 10`
**=	`x **= 10`	`x = x ** 10`
//=	`x //= 10`	`x = x // 10`

Here are some comparison operators.

Comparison Operator	Name
==	Equal
!=	Not equal
>	Greater than
<	Less than
>=	Greater than or equal to
<=	Less than or equal to

.
Here are some logical, identity, and membership operators.

Operator	Description
`and`	Returns `True` if both statements are `True`
`or`	Returns `True` if one of the statements is `True`
`not`	Reverses the result, returns `False` if the result is `True`
`is`	Returns `True` if both variables are the same object
`is not`	Returns `True` if both variables are not the same object
`in`	Returns `True` if a sequence with the specified value is present in the object
`not in`	Returns `True` if a sequence with the specified value is not present in the object

1.4 Conditional Statements

The `if` statement evaluates an expression to determine its boolean value. If `True`, the code block inside the statement is executed. If `False`, the code block is skipped.

Example.

```
if grade >= 85:
    print("GPV: 4.0")
elif grade >= 80: # Python will move on to this if the original is False
    print("GPV: 3.7")
elif grade >= 77: # Same for this, if both of the above are False
    print("GPV: 3.3")
else: # Code block will be executed if all of the above are False
    print("Is this Praxis?")
```

Notice that in Python, indentation is used to determine which statements belong together.

If we have a lot of cases, we may wish to use a `match` statement instead.

Example.

```
match color:
    case "red":
        print("Roses are red.")
    case "yellow" | "green": # We can check for more than one value match
        print("Grass is green, yellow if dead.")
    case "blue": if time == "day" # We can add an extra condition check
        print("The sky is blue.")
    case _: # This will execute if there are no matches
        print("This color is boring.")
```

1.5 Loops

A `for` loop is used for iterating over a sequence (a list, a tuple, a set, or a string). Most commonly, we use the `range` data type, which represents an immutable sequence of numbers.

Example.

```
for i in range(3): # Notice how by default, we begin at 0
    print("I am", i)

print(" ")

for i in range(3, 10, 3): # Syntax is (start, stop, step)
    print("I am", i)
```

Output.

```
I am 0
I am 1
I am 2

I am 3
I am 6
I am 9
```

A `while` loop will execute a set of statements as long as a condition is `True`. If the condition is always `True`, we could end up in an infinite loop.

Example.

```
height = 1
while True: # This loop will continue forever, unless...
    print("I am", height, "feet tall!")
    height += 1
    if height > 6:
        break # This will exit the loop
```

Output.

```
I am 1 feet tall!
I am 2 feet tall!
I am 3 feet tall!
I am 4 feet tall!
I am 5 feet tall!
I am 6 feet tall!
```

Observe the use of `break` above. If we wish to stop the current iteration but stay in the loop, we can use `continue`. We can also use an `else` statement to run a block of code when the condition is no longer `True`. This means that exiting the loop using `break` will not run the code inside the `else` statement.

1.6 Strings

Strings in Python are arrays of unicode characters. However, since Python doesn't have a character data type, a character is simply a string with length 1.

Here are some common string methods. Note that there are many others, these are just the most common.

Syntax	Description
`s[i]`	Get the character at position `i`
`len(s)`	Returns the length of `s`
`str0 in s`	Checks if `str0` is in `s`
`s[start:stop:step]`	Extracts a portion of `s`
`s.upper()`	Returns `s` in upper case
`s.lower()`	Returns `s` in lower case
`s.strip()`	Returns `s` without leading/trailing whitespace
`s.replace(str1, str2)`	Returns `s`, replacing `str1` with `str2`
`s.split(char)`	Returns a list of substrings, with separator `char`

Python allows negative indexing. Also, since strings are arrays, we can loop through the characters in a string with a `for` loop.

Example.

```
i = 1
for char in "mathematics":
    print((char * i) + (" " * 2 * (11 - i)) + (char * i))
    i += 1
```

Output.

```
m                    m
aa                  aa
ttt                ttt
hhhh              hhhh
eeeee            eeeee
mmmmmm          mmmmmm
aaaaaaa        aaaaaaa
tttttttt      tttttttt
iiiiiiiii    iiiiiiiii
ccccccccc  ccccccccc
sssssssssssssssssssss
```

1.7 Functions

A function is defined using the `def` keyword. To call a function, write its name followed by parentheses.

Example.

```
def print_hello():
    print("Hello there!")

print_hello()
```

Output.

```
Hello there!
```

Functions can send data back to the code that called them using the `return` statement. When a function reaches a `return` statement, it stops executing and sends the result back. If a function doesn't have a `return` statement, it returns `None` by default.

We can also pass information into functions as arguments. These are specified after the function name, inside the parentheses. You can also assign default values to parameters.

Example.

```
def greeting_message(name1, name2 = "alien"): # name2 has a default value
    return "Hi " + name1 + ", hello " + name2 + "!"

greeting_message("cat", "dog") # Nothing is printed (why?)
print(greeting_message("cow")) # Here we exclude a second argument
```

Output.

```
Hi cow, hello alien!
```

If you do not know how many arguments will be passed into your function, add a $*$ before the parameter name to send a tuple of arguments. You can also add a $**$ before the parameter name to send the function a dictionary of arguments.

1.8 User Input

You can use `input()` to ask the user for input. You can include a prompt inside the parentheses, which is a message that will display before the user input on the same line. The input from the user is always treated as a string.

1.9 Lists and Tuples

Lists and tuples are used to store multiple items in a single variable. Lists are mutable and use square brackets, whereas tuples are immutable and use parentheses. Items in lists and tuples are ordered and allow duplicate values.

Items are also indexed, the first item has index `[0]`, the second item has index `[1]`, etc. Lists and tuples can contain different data types. To determine how many items a tuple or list has, use the `len()` function. You can check if an item is present in a list or tuple using the `in` keyword.

To insert a new list item without replacing any of the existing values, we can use the `insert()` method. To add an item to the end of the list, use the `append()` method. To append items from another list to the current list, use the `extend()` method. To remove a item, use the `remove()` method. If there is more than one item with the specified value, the `remove()` method removes the first occurrence. The `pop()` method removes the specified index. If you do not specify the index, the `pop()` method removes the last item.

List objects have a `sort()` method that will sort the list alphanumerically, ascending, by default. To sort descending, use the keyword argument `reverse = True`. The `reverse()` method reverses the current sorting order of the elements. To copy a list, you can use the `copy()` method.

For lists and tuples, you can use the `count()` method to return the number of elements with the specified value. You can also use the `index()` method to return the position of where a specified value is found.

1.10 Dictionaries

Dictionaries are used to score data values in key:value pairs. They are unordered (in Python 3.3), mutable, and use curly brackets. Similarly to lists and tuples, you can use the `len()` function to see how many items a dictionary has.

You can access an item of a dictionary by referring to its key name inside square brackets. There is also a method called `get()` that will give you the same result. The `keys()` method will return a list of all the keys in the dictionary. The `values()` method will return a list of all the values in the dictionary. The `items`. method will return each item in a dictionary, as tuples in a list. To determine if a specified key is present in a dictionary use the `in` keyword.

Adding an item to a dictionary is done by using a new index key and assigning a value to it. The `update()` method will update the dictionary with the items from a given argument. If the item does not exist, the item will be added. The `pop()` method removes the item with the specified key name. To copy a dictionary, you can use the `copy()` method.